PRIMARY MARKET RESEARCH

CONSUMER APPLIANCES · THAILAND · SUPPLIER SOURCING

Thailand Home Coffee Machines

Market research and supplier qualification brief: assessing Thailand as a second market, and what its regulatory and cost structure demands of a Chinese manufacturing partner.

PREPARED FOR	Koke
SUBJECT	Home coffee machine category entry, Thai market
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HEADLINE	Recommend against mid-market entry on present evidence

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Document control

TITLE	Thailand Home Coffee Machines — Market Research & Supplier Qualification Brief
PURPOSE	To assess Thailand as a market for home coffee machine category entry, and to establish the supplier-qualification criteria that the Thai regulatory regime imposes on a Chinese contract manufacturer.
RELATIONSHIP	Companion to the Australian brief of 20 October 2026. The analytical framework is carried over unchanged so the two markets can be compared directly; Section 6 sets out that comparison.
COMMISSIONED BY	Koke
DATE OF RESEARCH	25 October 2026. Retail pricing captured on this date.
BASIS OF PREPARATION	Primary collection from Thai regulatory publications and marketplace listings, supplemented by published industry survey and channel data. Methodology at Appendix A; source register at Appendix B.
EVIDENCE ASYMMETRY	**This brief rests on a materially thinner evidence base than the Australian report.** No owner-review corpus was mined and Thai marketplace pages resisted systematic collection. Conclusions are correspondingly less firm. See Appendix C.
LIMITATIONS	Based on publicly available information. Does not constitute legal, tax or engineering advice. Regulatory scope must be confirmed with TISI or a licensed agent before commitment.
CURRENCY	Thai baht (฿) unless otherwise stated. Conversions at approximately 34.5 THB/USD and 22.4 THB/AUD, stated where applied.

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Executive summary

Six findings. The recommendation is negative, and the reasoning is set out so it can be challenged.

Thailand presents well on the metrics people usually cite when choosing a coffee market — consumption has nearly doubled, café culture is pervasive, and a domestic specialty movement is maturing. Those metrics do not translate into a viable machine-import business. The value of the machine market is growing at roughly half the Australian rate, the price point where demand concentrates is already served by Thai brands at a cost an importer cannot match, and the regulatory regime imposes an on-site audit of the Chinese factory that most candidate suppliers will not accommodate.

KF-01

Consumption is rising but market value is not

Per-capita consumption has climbed from roughly 180 to over 340 cups a year and the domestic coffee market is worth about ฿65 billion. Yet the coffee machine market, at roughly USD 95 million, is forecast to grow at only **2.92% a year** — approximately half Australia's 5.83%. Thais are drinking far more coffee, overwhelmingly bought from cafés and vendors rather than made on an owned machine. See Section 1.

KF-02

A Thai incumbent already sells the target specification below import cost

Duchess, a domestic brand, sells a 58 mm-portafilter, 20-bar machine at **฿3,990** — roughly USD 115. That is at or below the landed cost of an equivalent imported machine once certification and channel costs are carried. The mid-market is not underserved; it is served at a price an importer cannot profitably meet. See Sections 2 and 4.

KF-03

The regulatory gate requires a physical audit of the Chinese factory

Household appliances fall under TIS 1375-2563, mandatory since November 2020. Unlike Australia's document-based certification, TISI requires **on-site inspection of the production facility wherever it is located** — a one-to-three-day audit of the Chinese plant by a TISI-authorised body. This is the single hardest supplier filter in either market. See Section 3.

KF-04

The licence cannot be held by the manufacturer

A Thai-registered entity must be appointed as licence holder; a foreign manufacturer cannot hold TISI certification. Structurally this mirrors Australia's Responsible Supplier rule and carries the same consequence — the legal exposure sits with the local entity, not the factory. See Section 3.

KF-05

The channel is social commerce, not retail

Shopee, TikTok Shop and Lazada account for over **98.8%** of Thai e-commerce, with TikTok Shop alone at about a third and growing. Household appliances transact 34.3% online. This is a live-selling and creator-affiliate market requiring a different operating model from Australia's retail chains. See Section 5.

KF-06

Duty is zero; that is not the constraint

Under the ASEAN–China Free Trade Agreement with a valid Form E, coffee machines enter at 0% duty, with 7% VAT recoverable for registered operators. As in Australia, tariffs are immaterial to the decision. The binding constraints are certification cost, the factory audit, and competing against a domestic cost base. See Section 4.

0.1 Recommendation

Do not enter Thailand as a second market on the strength of its coffee culture. On present evidence the mid-market is closed by domestic cost structure and the regulatory gate is operationally harder than Australia's. Three conditions would change this assessment, and are set out in Section 8: a genuine FOB advantage below roughly USD 85; a defensible position above ฿15,000 where imported brands retain margin; or a specification Thai incumbents do not offer that buyers will pay for. Absent one of these, Thai market entry would consume the management attention that the Australian opportunity — where the evidence base is far stronger — currently warrants.

1. Market fundamentals

Why a strong coffee culture has not produced a strong machine market.

1.1 The growth paradox

The Thai coffee machine market is valued at approximately **USD 95 million**, forecast to add around USD 7.2 million by 2031 — a compound annual growth rate of **2.92%**. Set against Australia's 5.83% on a market more than twice the size, Thailand is both smaller and slower in value terms.

This sits oddly beside the consumption data. Per-capita coffee consumption has risen from roughly 180 cups a year to over 340, and the domestic coffee market reached about ฿65 billion in 2025. Thailand is unambiguously drinking more coffee.

The reconciliation is that Thai coffee consumption is overwhelmingly *purchased* rather than *produced at home*. Café Amazon alone operates one of the largest café networks in Southeast Asia, and street and convenience-store coffee is inexpensive and ubiquitous. A machine at home competes against a cup that costs a fraction of its Australian equivalent, which compresses both the willingness to pay and the perceived payback.

> THE STRUCTURAL CONTRAST WITH AUSTRALIA
>
> In Australia the café is expensive and the home machine is bought as a *capability upgrade* by buyers who continue visiting cafés anyway — 72% of them. In Thailand the café is cheap and abundant, so a home machine is a *substitution* purchase that must justify itself against a low reference price. The same product is being sold into two opposite value propositions.

1.2 Consumption rises, value does not

Reported segment preference across Thailand and Vietnam runs toward **affordable drip and capsule models** rather than the premium espresso equipment driving Australian value growth. Where Australia's growth is concentrated in bean-to-cup and prosumer machines, Thailand's volume sits at the accessible end — exactly the segment facing the heaviest price competition and the thinnest margins.

Household appliances more broadly transact 34.3% online, with the online channel growing at a 7.9% CAGR — faster than the machine category itself, which indicates channel shift rather than category expansion.

1.3 A domestic specialty movement

Thailand has a genuine and growing specialty coffee sector built on domestic production, notably from the northern highlands. This supports a rising enthusiast population that does buy serious equipment. It is the one demand pocket with real premium potential, and it is the basis of the third exception in Section 8 — but it is a narrow base, and it is contested by established imported brands that already hold shelf presence and credibility with exactly those buyers.

2. Competitive landscape

Observed Thai marketplace listings, captured 25 October 2026.

2.1 The price ladder

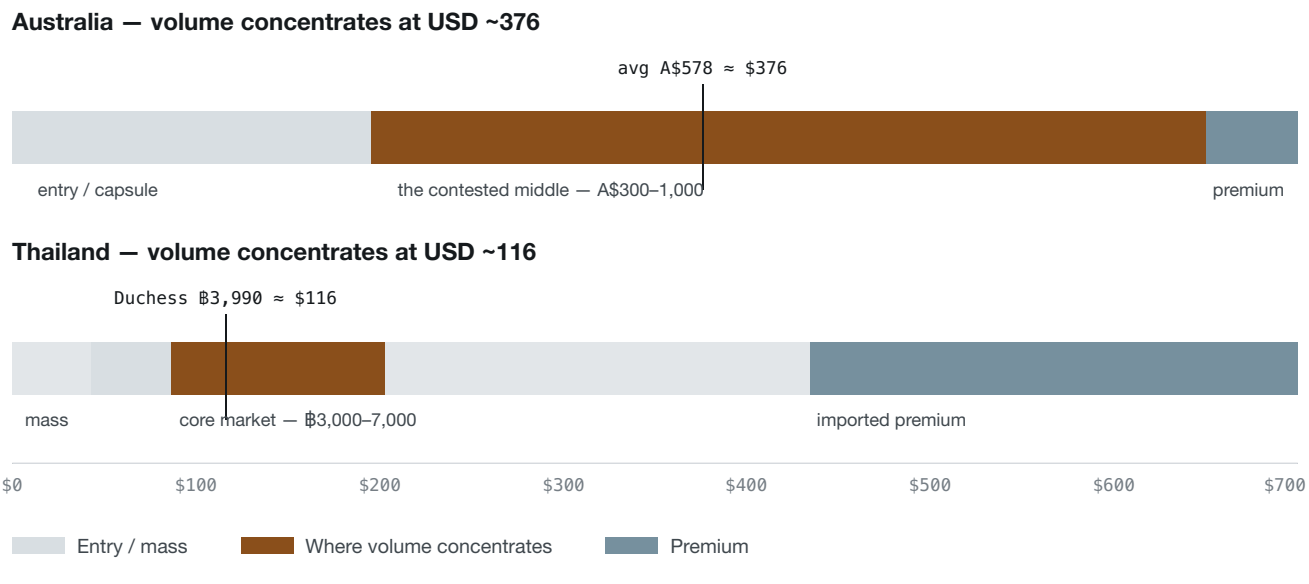
Thai marketplace listings carry heavy and frequent coupon discounting, so list and transacted prices diverge materially. The figures below are the prices observed at capture, with the caveat noted at Appendix C.

TABLE 1 · Thai retail price ladder, observed listings. USD conversion at approximately 34.5 THB/USD.

MACHINE	฿ OBSERVED	≈ USD	NOTES
MASS ENTRY			
Worldtech Xpresso 3-in-1 WT-CM404	1,934	56	Semi-automatic; price after a 67% coupon — illustrative of discount depth
CORE MARKET — WHERE DEMAND CONCENTRATES			
Duchess CM5810B	3,990	116	Thai brand; 58 mm portafilter, 20 bar, pressure gauge. The benchmark that governs the entry case
Duchess CM5810B (alternate listing)	4,550	132	Same model, different seller and coupon state
Nespresso Essenza Mini (bundle)	6,600	191	Capsule; bundled with five coffee sleeves
Nespresso Pixie	7,100	206	Capsule
IMPORTED PREMIUM			
Breville The Bambino BES450	18,000	522	Imported brand; the band where margin survives

Lazada Thailand alone lists approximately 4,483 coffee machine products — an extremely fragmented long tail dominated by local and white-label brands not individually catalogued here.

FIGURE 1 · Where demand sits in each market, normalised to USD. Australian bands converted at 0.65 USD/AUD; Thai bands at 34.5 THB/USD.



Thailand's entire core market sits inside — and below — Australia's entry band. The two markets do not overlap where it matters.

2.2 The incumbent cost problem

The Duchess CM5810B is the central fact of this brief. It offers a 58 mm portafilter and 20-bar pump — effectively the specification identified as the Australian target configuration — at **฿3,990, roughly USD 115**. Published Chinese factory quotations for a comparable grinder-equipped machine run USD 135–235 FOB, and USD 102–108 for a simpler 15-bar semi-automatic without grinder.

In other words, a Thai domestic brand retails at or below the *factory cost* of an imported equivalent, before freight, certification, channel commission or margin. A foreign-branded entrant attempting the Thai mid-market would be competing below its own cost base from the first unit.

> WHAT WOULD HAVE TO BE TRUE FOR THIS TO BE WRONG
>
> This conclusion depends on two things that should be tested before accepting it. First, that the ฿3,990 price is sustained rather than a promotional floor — Thai marketplace discounting is aggressive and a coupon price is not a price. Second, that Duchess is not operating at negative or negligible margin to hold share. If either is false, the band may be less closed than it appears. Both are checkable with a few weeks of price tracking and are listed at Appendix C.

3. Regulatory requirements

Thai Industrial Standards Institute certification, and the requirement with no Australian equivalent.

3.1 Classification and scope

Thailand regulates electrical appliances through a general mandatory standard rather than, as Australia does, a product-specific risk classification. The governing standard is **TIS 1375-2563**, "Household and similar electrical appliances — Safety: General requirements", modified from IEC 60335-1 Ed. 5.2 (2016-05).

Its scope covers appliances for household and similar purposes with rated voltage not exceeding 250 V for single-phase appliances. A domestic coffee machine sits squarely within that scope. The standard became enforceable on **25 November 2020**, 180 days after publication. As of 2025 there are approximately 136 mandatory product categories, of which the electrical and electronic group is the largest single block.

> A SCOPE QUESTION THAT MUST BE ANSWERED BEFORE COMMITTING
>
> Because Thailand works from a general standard, confirming that a specific model is in scope — and whether any additional product-specific standard also applies — requires a direct determination from TISI or a licensed agent. **Scope should never be inferred from a general standard.** This is the single highest-priority verification item in this brief, and it is inexpensive to resolve.

3.2 The compliance chain

TABLE 2 · TISI compliance chain for a mandatory-standard household appliance.

STEP	REQUIREMENT	RESPONSIBLE PARTY / DURATION
Appoint licence holder	**A Thai-registered company must be the licence holder.** A foreign manufacturer cannot hold TISI certification.	Own Thai entity, or a qualified local importer
Application and documentation	Technical file submitted to TISI	Licence holder
Sample testing	Testing against TIS 1375-2563 at an approved laboratory	30–60 days
Factory inspection	**On-site audit at the production facility, wherever located** — i.e. at the Chinese plant	1–3 days on site
Technical review and licence issue	TISI review and determination	8–12 weeks typical; 3–6 months if complex
Marking and labelling	TIS mark on product and packaging, plus Thai-language labelling	Required before sale
Electrical configuration	220 V / 50 Hz; TIS 166-2549 plug standard (Type O)	Factory tooling

3.3 The factory audit requirement

This is the decisive operational difference between the two markets, and it deserves to be stated plainly.

Australia's EESS regime, though it sits at the highest risk tier and demands third-party certification, is **documentary**. A certificate from a recognised body, backed by laboratory test evidence, satisfies it. Nobody visits the factory.

Thailand's regime is **physical**. A TISI-authorised inspection body audits the manufacturing facility on site for one to three days, in China, before the licence issues. The practical consequences are substantial:

- **Many factories will decline.** Hosting a foreign regulatory audit requires documented process control, traceability and a willingness to open the plant. A supplier content to ship against a CE declaration will often simply refuse.
- **It changes who you can work with.** The filter selects for larger, export-mature factories with existing audit experience — which are also the factories least likely to quote at the bottom of the FOB range the Thai price point demands.
- **It is a real cost line, and a variable one.** Inspection cost depends on location and scope and must be quoted, not estimated. It is carried in Section 4 as an assumption, flagged accordingly.
- **It lengthens the timeline.** Eight to twelve weeks is the stated typical case and assumes a cooperative factory with documentation in order.

The audit requirement and the Duchess price point compound each other: the factories capable of passing a TISI audit are generally not the factories that can quote low enough to compete with a domestic brand at ฿3,990.

4. Landed cost model

Indicative only. Assumptions stated; the certification line is the least reliable.

The model below assumes FOB USD 115 — the low end of published quotations for a grinder-equipped machine, chosen deliberately to test the entry case under favourable assumptions — at approximately 34.5 THB/USD.

TABLE 3 · Indicative landed cost model, ฿ per unit, at a 1,000-unit first run.

LINE ITEM	BASIS	฿ PER UNIT
FOB factory price	USD 115 at 34.5 THB/USD	3,970
Sea freight and insurance	Short lane from China	240
Import duty	0% under ACFTA with valid Form E	0
VAT	7%, recoverable for registered operators	0
Certification amortisation	Testing, factory audit and licence, over 1,000 units — **assumption, obtain a quotation**	420
Warehousing and domestic delivery	Thailand	320
Platform commission and returns	Marketplace-led channel	640
Total landed cost		**5,590**
Competing Thai retail price	**Duchess CM5810B, comparable specification**	**3,990**

4.1 The margin arithmetic

The model lands at **฿5,590 before any gross margin**, against an incumbent retailing the same specification at **฿3,990**. The gap is roughly ฿1,600 per unit, or 40% of the competing retail price — and this is on a deliberately favourable FOB assumption, before marketing, before brand-building, and before the working capital cost of a first import.

No plausible adjustment closes that gap at the mid-market price point. Halving the certification amortisation saves ฿210. Eliminating platform commission entirely saves ฿640. Both together still leave the landed cost above the competing retail price.

> WHERE THE ARITHMETIC DOES WORK
>
> At the imported-premium band — Breville's Bambino at ฿18,000 — a landed cost near ฿5,590 leaves substantial room. The question that follows is not whether margin exists above ฿15,000 but whether a new brand can win share there against established names with existing distribution and credibility, in a market whose enthusiast base is narrow. That is a brand and distribution problem rather than a sourcing problem, and this brief does not answer it.

5. Route to market

Platform concentration and what it demands operationally.

Thai e-commerce is extremely concentrated and structurally different from Australia's retail-chain market. Three platforms account for over **98.8%** of the market, and the fastest-growing of them is a social-video platform.

TABLE 4 · Thai e-commerce platform structure and implications for a new appliance brand.

PLATFORM	SHARE	CHARACTER AND IMPLICATION
Shopee	~48–50%	Market leader; price-led, coupon-driven, heavy promotional cadence. Competing here means competing on discount depth.
TikTok Shop	~33%	Up from 27% in 2024; approximately ฿54.4 billion revenue in 2025, now ahead of Lazada. Live selling and creator affiliates, not search-led retail.
Lazada	~18%	Ceding volume while repositioning toward premium — potentially the most hospitable of the three for an imported brand.

The operating implications differ sharply from the Australian route to market, where the sequence runs direct-to-consumer, then marketplace, then retail chains:

- **Content production is the marketing function.** A third of the market moves through live selling and creator affiliates. This requires continuous video assets, creator relationships and promotional cadence — a capability, not a campaign.
- **SKU and colourway flexibility matters more than in Australia.** Content-led channels reward visual novelty, which argues for a factory able to run short variant batches rather than one optimised for single-SKU volume.
- **Reorder responsiveness is a channel requirement.** A live-selling spike is unservable on a long reorder lead time.
- **Discount depth is structural.** The 67% coupon observed on one listing in Table 1 is not anomalous. Pricing strategy must assume persistent promotional pressure rather than treating it as exceptional.

6. Comparison with Australia

The two markets side by side, using the same framework.

Because both briefs apply the same analytical framework, they can be compared directly. The comparison is the clearest statement of why Thailand is the harder entry.

TABLE 5 · Australia and Thailand compared across the framework's decision points.

DECISION POINT	AUSTRALIA	THAILAND
Market value	USD 210M, to USD 295M by 2031	USD 95M, to ~USD 102M by 2031
Value CAGR	5.83%	2.92%
Where volume sits	A$450–1,000 (USD 290–650)	฿3,000–7,000 (USD 87–203)
Buyer motivation	Capability upgrade; café remains expensive and is still used by 72% of buyers	Substitution against cheap, ubiquitous café and street coffee
Quality variance in target band	Wide — ratings 2.8 to 4.7, no incumbent moat	Not measured; no owner-review corpus mined
Domestic incumbent	Kogan at 2.8★ — a cautionary tale, not a cost barrier	Duchess at ฿3,990 — a genuine cost barrier
Regulatory regime	EESS Level 3, AS/NZS 60335.2.15	TIS 1375-2563, general mandatory standard
Certification type	**Documentary** — certificate from recognised body	**Physical** — on-site audit of the Chinese factory
Licence holder	Responsible Supplier with Australian ABN	Thai-registered entity
Typical timeline	Weeks, document-driven	8–12 weeks; 3–6 months if complex
Duty from China	0% under ChAFTA	0% under ACFTA
Channel	Retail chains concentrated; JB Hi-Fi owns The Good Guys; DTC viable first step	98.8% in three platforms; TikTok Shop ~33%; social commerce
Consumer law exposure	High — statutory guarantees run to reasonable product life	Not assessed in this brief
Assessment	**Viable with disciplined execution**	**Not recommended on present evidence**

> A CAUTION ABOUT THIS TABLE
>
> Two rows read "not measured" or "not assessed". That asymmetry is real and material: the Australian conclusions rest on a mined corpus of 201 owner reviews and a verified regulatory reading, while the Thai conclusions rest on marketplace listings and secondary forecasts. **The Thai case is argued from cost structure and regulation, which are reasonably firm, not from measured product quality, which was not collected.** A reader minded to challenge the negative recommendation should start there — see Appendix C.

7. Supplier qualification framework

If Thailand is pursued regardless, these are the filters — reordered for the Thai regime.

The Australian framework carries over, with the filter order changed. In Australia, certification capability comes first because it is free to test and eliminates most candidates. In Thailand, the audit question comes first for the same reason, and a commercial viability test is promoted to second place because the cost arithmetic in Section 4 can terminate the project before any technical work is done.

FILTER 1 **Will the factory host a TISI audit?** expect >85% eliminated

This filter has no Australian equivalent and is the sharpest in either market. Ask it first; it is free and it is terminal.

- **Have you hosted a TISI factory inspection before?** For which licence holder, for which product, and when?
- **Will you accept an on-site audit** by a TISI-authorised body, one to three days, and on what cost-sharing basis?
- **Are you currently associated with any live TIS licence,** and under which Thai importer?
- **Can you supply TIS 1375-2563 test evidence,** or an IEC 60335-1 CB report to build from?
- **What audit findings have you received previously,** and how were they closed out?

`Has hosted a TISI audit → shortlist` `Will not host inspection → eliminate`

FILTER 2 **Can the business case survive ฿3,990?** commercial viability

Promoted above the technical filters because Section 4 shows the arithmetic can end the project. Confront it before spending on samples or testing.

- **What is the true FOB at the volume you can commit to in year one,** not at the supplier's headline volume?
- **Does the case survive if retail must sit at or below ฿4,500?** If not, the mid-market is closed.
- **Is there a defensible position above ฿15,000** where imported brands retain margin — and can the brand win there?
- **Is there a specification Thai incumbents do not offer** that buyers demonstrably pay for?
- **Track the Duchess price for four weeks** before accepting ฿3,990 as the real floor.

`Clear cost or specification advantage` `Undifferentiated mid-market entry → stop`

FILTER 3 **Build quality for a humid, hard-water market** determines return rate

The engineering questions from the Australian study transfer directly — sealing was found to be the dominant differentiator there — with two local additions. Thai humidity and water hardness load the sealing and scaling failure modes harder than Australian conditions do.

- **Sealing specification** at steam wand and thermoblock: material, supplier, pressure-cycle test count. Request the protocol, not an assurance.
- **Pump brand** — specify Ulka or Ceme contractually rather than accepting "equivalent".
- **Humidity and corrosion evidence** — damp-heat and salt-spray test results, which Australian sourcing would not necessarily require.
- **Descaling design and indicator logic** given local water hardness.
- **Batch defect rates and twelve months of return data.**

`Supplies environmental test data` `No test evidence → trading intermediary`

FILTER 4 **Marketplace and content readiness** channel fit

A consequence of Section 5. A factory optimised for single-SKU retail volume is a poor fit for a social-commerce market.

- **Can you support short-run SKU and colourway variation** for content cadence?
- **Is packaging suitable for marketplace fulfilment** and unboxing video?
- **Will you supply product footage, exploded diagrams and specification assets** for creator briefs?
- **What is the reorder lead time,** and can it chase a live-selling spike?

`Flexible short runs` `Rigid high-MOQ only`

8. Recommendation

The negative case, and the three conditions that would reverse it.

On the evidence collected, **Thailand should not be entered as a home coffee machine market**. The reasoning is cumulative rather than resting on any single finding:

1. Machine-market value grows at roughly half the Australian rate despite a far more visible coffee culture, because Thai coffee consumption is purchased rather than produced at home.
2. The price band where demand concentrates is served by a domestic brand at or below the landed cost of an imported equivalent, and no plausible cost adjustment closes that gap.
3. The regulatory gate requires a physical audit of the Chinese factory, which eliminates most candidate suppliers and selects for exactly the larger factories least able to quote at the price the market demands.
4. The channel requires a continuous content and live-selling capability that is a different operating model from the one the Australian opportunity needs.

Each of these is survivable alone. Together they describe a market that would absorb substantial management attention for a structurally worse return than the Australian opportunity, where the evidence base is also far stronger.

8.1 Three conditions that would reverse this

- **A genuine FOB advantage below approximately USD 85.** This is the level at which the Section 4 model lands under the competing retail price with room for margin. If a qualified factory — one that will host a TISI audit — quotes there at committable volume, the mid-market case reopens and should be re-modelled.
- **A defensible premium position above ฿15,000.** The arithmetic works in that band. The open question is brand and distribution, not sourcing, and would need its own assessment against the established imported names.
- **A specification gap Thai incumbents do not serve.** The domestic specialty coffee movement described in Section 1.3 is the most plausible pocket. It is narrow and contested, but it is the one place where a differentiated product could command price.

8.2 If the decision is to proceed regardless

Run Filter 1 and Filter 2 from Section 7 before any other expenditure. Both are cheap, both are terminal, and between them they will resolve the viability question within a few weeks. Obtain a real TISI scope determination and a real certification quotation including the factory audit at the same time, since both are assumptions in this brief rather than measured figures. Do not order samples or commission testing until those four answers are in hand.

Appendix A. Methodology

Collection and analysis procedures, and how they differ from the Australian study.

A.1 Framework

The analytical framework is carried over unchanged from the Australian brief of 20 October 2026, so that the two markets can be compared on identical decision points. The framework orders the entry question as: regulatory admissibility first, because it is cheap to test and most likely to disqualify; then the price band where demand concentrates and whether incumbents hold a quality moat there; then manufactured quality expressed as questions a factory must answer with test protocols; then after-sales and statutory exposure.

A.2 Collection

Regulatory requirements were established from TISI publications and from certification-body descriptions of the licensing process, cross-read across multiple independent accounts to confirm the licence-holder and factory-inspection requirements, which are the load-bearing regulatory findings.

Retail pricing was collected from Thai marketplace listings on 25 October 2026. Direct scraping of Lazada, Power Buy and HomePro category pages was attempted and failed — all three serve JavaScript-rendered catalogues that resist standard collection — so prices were obtained from indexed listing data rather than systematic category capture. This is a weaker method than the Australian collection and is reflected in Appendix C.

Channel share, consumption and market-size figures are from published industry and press sources, listed at Appendix B.

A.3 Analysis not performed

The comparative failure-mode analysis that produced the central finding of the Australian brief — mining 201 full-text owner reviews to isolate water sealing as the dominant quality differentiator — **was not replicated for Thailand**. No equivalent Thai review corpus was collected. The engineering priorities in Section 7, Filter 3 are therefore carried over from the Australian analysis on the assumption that failure modes are a property of the product category rather than the market, with humidity and water hardness added as local factors. That assumption is reasonable but untested here.

Appendix B. Source register

Sources relied upon, classified by evidence type.

[1] Thai Industrial Standards Institute (TISI) — TIS 1375-2563, "Household and similar electrical appliances — Safety: General requirements", modified from IEC 60335-1 Ed. 5.2; mandatory from 25 November 2020; scope ≤250 V single-phase.
PRIMARY — REGULATORY STANDARD

[2] Certification-body and market-access descriptions of the TISI licensing process — licence-holder restriction to Thai-registered entities, mandatory overseas factory inspection of 1–3 days, 8–12 week typical timeline, approximately 136 mandatory product categories as of 2025. Cross-read across multiple independent accounts.
SECONDARY — CERTIFICATION PRACTICE, CORROBORATED

[3] Thai marketplace listings, captured 25 October 2026 — Duchess CM5810B, Worldtech WT-CM404, Nespresso Essenza Mini and Pixie, Breville Bambino BES450. Prices as displayed including coupon state.
PRIMARY — COLLECTED FOR THIS REPORT

[4] Thailand coffee machine market sizing and forecast — approximately USD 95 million, 2.92% CAGR to 2031, +USD 7.2 million by 2031.
SECONDARY — SINGLE COMMERCIAL FORECAST

[5] Thai coffee consumption data — per-capita rise from approximately 180 to over 340 cups per year; domestic coffee market approximately ฿65 billion in 2025.
SECONDARY — INDUSTRY AND PRESS REPORTING

[6] Thai e-commerce platform share — Shopee approximately 48–50%, TikTok Shop approximately 33% (฿54.4 billion revenue 2025), Lazada approximately 18%; three platforms above 98.8% combined; household appliances 34.3% transacted online with 7.9% online CAGR.
SECONDARY — MARKET RESEARCH AND PRESS

[7] Thai customs and ACFTA treatment — HS 8516.71.00, 0% duty with valid Form E, 7% VAT, landed cost typically 12–18% above FOB on the China lane.
SECONDARY — TRADE AND LOGISTICS GUIDANCE

[8] Published Chinese supplier quotations — USD 102–108 FOB for 15-bar semi-automatic without grinder at MOQ 500; USD 135–235 FOB for 20-bar with integrated grinder at MOQ from 50.
SECONDARY — PUBLIC SUPPLIER LISTINGS

[9] Companion report: *Australian Home Coffee Machines — Market Research & Supplier Qualification Brief*, v2.0, 20 October 2026. Source of the framework and of the carried-over engineering priorities.
INTERNAL — PRIOR RESEARCH

Appendix C. Limitations and qualifications

Read before acting on the recommendation. This brief is less firmly grounded than its Australian companion.

C.1 Material limitations

1. **No owner-review corpus was collected.** The Australian brief's central contribution was a comparative failure-mode analysis across 201 full-text reviews. Nothing equivalent exists here. Any statement in this brief about product quality in the Thai market is inference, not measurement.
2. **Retail prices rest on coupon-state listings.** Thai marketplace discounting is aggressive and frequent — one observed listing carried a 67% coupon. The ฿3,990 Duchess price that anchors the commercial argument may be promotional rather than structural. Four weeks of price tracking would settle this and is the cheapest high-value verification available.
3. **Category capture failed.** Lazada, Power Buy and HomePro all serve JavaScript-rendered catalogues that resisted collection. The price ladder in Table 1 is a sample of indexed listings, not a systematic survey, and Lazada alone lists approximately 4,483 coffee machine products that were not catalogued.
4. **Market sizing rests on a single commercial forecast** and was not cross-validated against an independent source. The 2.92% CAGR is load-bearing in the recommendation and deserves a second source before the conclusion is treated as settled.
5. **The certification cost line is an assumption.** The ฿420 per-unit amortisation in Table 3 includes an estimated factory-audit cost. Audit pricing varies with location and scope and must be quoted. It is among the least reliable figures in the model.
6. **Regulatory scope requires confirmation.** Because Thailand regulates through a general standard, that a specific coffee machine model falls under TIS 1375-2563 — and whether a product-specific standard also applies — must be determined by TISI or a licensed agent. This brief infers scope from the standard's stated coverage; that inference is reasonable but is not a determination.
7. **Thai consumer protection law was not assessed.** The Australian brief treated statutory consumer guarantees as a material financial exposure. No equivalent analysis was performed for Thailand, and the comparison table at Section 6 records this as a gap rather than as an absence of risk.

C.2 How to challenge the recommendation

The negative recommendation rests on cost structure and regulation, which are the firmer parts of this evidence base, rather than on product quality, which was not measured. A reader who disagrees should attack it in this order: verify whether ฿3,990 is a sustained price; obtain a real certification and audit quotation; and obtain a genuine FOB quotation at committable volume from a factory that will host a TISI audit. If those three come back materially different from the assumptions here, the conclusion should be revisited rather than defended.

C.3 Scope of advice

This report is prepared from publicly available information for commercial planning purposes. It does not constitute legal, tax, customs or engineering advice. Regulatory obligations described at Section 3 should be confirmed with TISI or a licensed certification agent before commercial commitment.

END OF REPORT